

3 Counting

3.1 Counting Lists

2. Airports are identified with 3-letter codes. For example, the Richmond, Virginia airport has the code *RIC*, and Portland, Oregon has *PDX*. How many different 3-letter codes are possible?

There are $26 \cdot 26 \cdot 26 = 17576$ possible 3-letter codes that are different.

4. Five cards are dealt off of a standard 52-card deck and lined up in a row. How many such line-ups are there in which all 5 cards are of the same color (i.e., all black or all red)?

From a 52-card deck, there are 26 of each color, from each half we have $26 \cdot 25 \cdot 24 \cdot 23 \cdot 22 = 7,893,600$ line-ups where all 5 cards are of that same particular color, taking into consideration it can be either of the two colors, then we have $2 \cdot 7,893,600 = 15,787,200$ line-ups where all 5 cards are of the same color.

6. Five cards are dealt off a standard 52-card deck and lined up in a row. How many such line-ups are there in which exactly one of the 5 cards is a queen?

We have 5 positions to place one of the 4 queens, that is $4 \cdot 5 = 20$ different ways, the remaining 4 positions can be any of the remaining 48 cards that are not a queen, therefore there are $4 \cdot 5 \cdot 48 \cdot 47 \cdot 46 \cdot 45 = 93,398,400$ line-ups with such arrangement.

8. This problem concerns lists made from the symbols *A, B, C, D, E*.

a) How many such length-5 lists have at least one letter repeated?

b) How many such length-6 lists have at least one letter repeated?

- a) We have 5^5 different possible lists and $5!$ which don't repeat, thus we have $5^5 - 5! = 3005$ length-5 lists with at least one letter repeated.
- b) There are more positions than symbols, thus all possible length-6 lists have at least one letter repeated, so there are $5^6 = 15,625$ such lists which have at least one letter repeated.

10. This problem concerns lists made from the letters $A, B, C, D, E, F, G, H, I, J$.

- a) How many length-5 lists can be made from these letters if repetition is not allowed and the list must begin with a vowel?
- b) How many length-5 lists can be made from these letters if repetition is not allowed and the list must begin and end with a vowel?
- c) How many length-5 lists can be made from these letters if repetition is not allowed and the list must contain exactly one A?

- a) There are 3 vowels for the first position, the remaining 4 positions are filled from the other 9 without repetition, so there are $3 \cdot 9 \cdot 8 \cdot 7 \cdot 6 = 9,072$ such lists.
- b) There are 3 choices of vowel for the first position and 2 for the last, and the middle 3 positions are filled from the remaining 8 letters, so there are $3 \cdot 2 \cdot 8 \cdot 7 \cdot 6 = 2,016$ such lists.
- c) The single A can go in any of the 5 positions, and the remaining 4 positions are filled from the 9 letters that are not A , so there are $5 \cdot 9 \cdot 8 \cdot 7 \cdot 6 = 15,120$ such lists.

12. Consider the lists of length six made with the symbols P, R, O, F, S , where repetition is allowed. (For example, the following is such a list: (P, R, O, O, F, S) .) How many such lists can be made if the list must end in an S and the symbol O is used more than once?

The last position is fixed as S , leaving the first 5 positions free, so there are $5^5 = 3125$ lists ending in S . From these we subtract the ones where O appears fewer than two times: $4^5 = 1024$ lists with no O , and $5 \cdot 4^4 = 1280$ lists with exactly one O (5 positions for the O , the other 4 filled from the 4 remaining symbols). Thus there are $5^5 - 4^5 - 5 \cdot 4^4 = 821$ such lists.

3.2 Factorials

2. For which values of n does $n!$ have n or fewer digits?

We assume the problem refers to the length of the list of digits used to represent $n!$ for some n in base 10. If we let $D(n)$ represent the length of the list for such representation, then the problem statement can be written as $D(n) \leq n$.

From the *Basis Representation Theorem* we know we can represent any positive integer N uniquely in the form $N = \sum_{k=0}^m a_k 10^k$, $a_m \neq 0, a_k \in \{0, \dots, 9\}$. From this, we see the number of digits of N is exactly $m+1$, and also $10^m \leq N \leq 10^{m+1} - 1$.

If we let $N = n!$, and d be the number of digits of $n!$, then $10^{d-1} \leq n! \leq 10^d - 1 < 10^d$, so $d-1 \leq \log_{10}(n!) < d$ which is equivalent to $d = \lfloor \log_{10}(n!) \rfloor + 1$. Therefore we have $D(n) = \lfloor \log_{10}(n!) \rfloor + 1$.

Using *Stirling's formula*, if we let δ account for some error, then we have, $\log_{10}(n!) = \log_{10}(\sqrt{2\pi n}(\frac{n}{e})^n) + \delta \approx n \log_{10}(\frac{n}{e}) + \frac{1}{2} \log_{10}(2\pi n)$.

We can find an approximation to the *crossover* point where $\log_{10}(n!)$ grows like $n \log_{10}(\frac{n}{e})$ that is, $n \log_{10}(\frac{n}{e}) = n$, thus,

$$\begin{aligned} n \log_{10} \left(\frac{n}{e} \right) &= n \\ \log_{10} \left(\frac{n}{e} \right) &= 1 \\ \frac{n}{e} &= 10 \\ n &= 10e \approx 27.18 \end{aligned}$$

We try some discrete neighbor values:

$$28! = 304,888,344,611,713,860,501,504,000,000 \rightarrow 30 \text{ digits}$$

$$27! = 10,888,869,450,418,352,160,768,000,000 \rightarrow 29 \text{ digits}$$

$$26! = 403,291,461,126,605,635,584,000,000 \rightarrow 27 \text{ digits}$$

$$25! = 15,511,210,043,330,985,984,000,000 \rightarrow 26 \text{ digits}$$

$$24! = 620,448,401,733,239,439,360,000 \rightarrow 24 \text{ digits}$$

We see that when $n = 24$, then $n!$ has n or fewer digits, and the trend continues for $1 \leq n \leq 24$.

4. Using only pencil and paper, find the value of $\frac{100!}{95!}$.

$$\frac{100!}{95!} = \frac{100 \cdot 99 \cdot 98 \cdot 97 \cdot 96 \cdot 95 \cdot 94 \cdot 93 \cdot \dots}{95 \cdot 94 \cdot 93 \cdot \dots} = 100 \cdot 99 \cdot 98 \cdot 97 \cdot 96 = 9034502400$$

6. There are two 0's at the end of $10! = 3,628,800$. Using only pencil and paper, determine how many 0's are at the end of the number $100!$.

The question in hand is determining how many times is $100!$ divisible by 10, in other words, if $100! = 2^m \cdot 5^n \cdot \delta$ (where $5 \nmid \delta$ and $2 \nmid \delta$), then each pair of one 2 and one 5 makes a factor of 10:

$$2^m \cdot 5^n = 10^{\min(m,n)} \cdot 2^{m-\min(m,n)} \cdot 5^{n-\min(m,n)}$$

Since $100!$ contains more factors of 2 than factors of 5, then $m > n$, thus:

$$100! = 10^n \cdot 2^{m-n} \cdot \delta$$

So the number of trailing zeros is exactly n , and we obtain n by counting the multiples of 5 in $1 \dots 100$:

$$\frac{100}{5} = 20$$

So there is at least 20 trailing zeroes, but we have to account for factors that contribute more than one factor, which is the case of 25, 50, 75, 100:

$$25 = 5^2$$

$$50 = 2 \cdot 5^2$$

$$75 = 3 \cdot 5^2$$

$$100 = 4 \cdot 5^2$$

Hence we need to account for 5^2 's:

$$\frac{100}{25} = 4$$

Then we have that $100! = 2^m \cdot 5^{20+4} \cdot \delta \implies n = 20 + 4 = 24$, that is, there are 24 trailing zeroes.

8. Compute how many 7-digit numbers can be made from the digits 1,2,3,4,5,6,7 if there is no repetition and the odd digits must appear in an unbroken sequence.

There are $4! \cdot 4! = 576$ such numbers.

10. There is another significant function called Stirling's formula that provides an approximation to factorials. It states that $n! \approx \sqrt{2\pi n} \left(\frac{n}{e}\right)^n$. It is an

approximation to $n!$ in the sense that $\frac{n!}{\sqrt{2\pi n}(\frac{n}{e})^n}$ approaches 1 as n approaches ∞ . Use Stirling's formula to find approximations to $5!$, $10!$, $20!$ and $50!$.

Writing $S(n) = \sqrt{2\pi n} \left(\frac{n}{e}\right)^n$ for Stirling's approximation, we obtain:

$$S(5) \approx 118.02$$

$$S(10) \approx 3,598,695.62$$

$$S(20) \approx 2.4228 \times 10^{18}$$

$$S(50) \approx 3.0363 \times 10^{64}$$

3.3 Counting Subsets

2. Suppose A is a set for which $|A| = 100$. How many subsets of A have 5 elements? How many subsets have 10 elements? How many have 99 elements?

$$\binom{100}{5} = \frac{100!}{5!(100-5)!} = 75,287,520$$

$$\binom{100}{10} = \frac{100!}{10!(100-10)!} = 17,310,309,456,440$$

$$\binom{100}{99} = \frac{100!}{99!(100-99)!} = 100$$

4. Suppose a set B has the property that $|\{X : X \in \mathcal{P}(B), |X| = 6\}| = 28$. Find $|B|$.

From the problem statement we know that $\binom{|B|}{6} = 28$, since 28 is small, we check neighbor values of 6:

$$\binom{6}{6} = 1$$

$$\binom{7}{6} = 7$$

$$\binom{8}{6} = 28$$

So we see that $|B| = 8$.

6. $|\{X \in \mathcal{P}(\{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9\}) : |X| = 4\}| =$

$$\binom{10}{4} = 210$$

8. This problem concerns lists made from the symbols $A, B, C, D, E, F, G, H, I, J$.

- a) How many length-5 lists can be made if repetition is not allowed and the list is in alphabetical order? (Example: $BDEFI$ or $ABCGH$, but not $BADGH$.)
- b) How many length-5 lists can be made if repetition is not allowed and the list is not in alphabetical order?

a) There are $\binom{10}{5} = 252$ ways to choose 5 letters from 10.

b) Since repetition is not allowed, there are $\frac{10!}{5!} = 30,240$ such lists, from the previous question we know there are 252 lists in alphabetical order, therefore, there are $30,240 - 252 = 29,988$ such lists.

10. A department consists of 5 men and 7 women. From this department you select a committee with 3 men and 2 women. In how many ways can you do this?

There are $\binom{5}{3} \cdot \binom{7}{2} = 210$ different ways to create the committee.

12. Twenty-one people are to be divided into two teams, the Red Team and the Blue Team. There will be 10 people on Red Team and 11 people on Blue Team. In how many ways can this be done?

This can be done $\binom{21}{10} = 352,716$ different ways.

14. Suppose $n, k \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $0 \leq k \leq n$. Use Definition 3.2 alone (without using Fact 3.3) to show that $\binom{n}{k} = \binom{n}{n-k}$.

Let S be a set with $|S| = n$. By Definition 3.2, $\binom{n}{k}$ is the number of k -element subsets of S , and $\binom{n}{n-k}$ is the number of $(n-k)$ -element subsets of S .

Consider pairing each subset $A \subseteq S$ with its complement $S - A$. If $|A| = k$, then $|S - A| = n - k$, so this pairs every k -element subset with an $(n - k)$ -element subset. Furthermore, taking the complement twice returns the original set, since $S - (S - A) = A$; hence each $(n - k)$ -element subset is paired back with exactly one k -element subset, with none left out or counted twice.

So the k -element subsets and the $(n - k)$ -element subsets are in exact one-to-one correspondence, and therefore equal in number. By Definition 3.2, $\binom{n}{k} = \binom{n}{n-k}$.